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WHITEPAPER · AI AND COMMERCIAL OPERATIONS

Human-approved AI at the order desk: where WhatsApp orders meet the ERP

A practical view for wholesalers and distributors on what to automate, what to keep human, and how to know it works.

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October 2026

Executive summary

1. In Turkish wholesale and distribution, a large share of orders still arrives as WhatsApp messages, voice notes and phone calls, and is then re-keyed into the ERP by hand. The cost shows up as staff time, order errors and slower collections.
2. Language models can now read these messages well enough to prepare a draft order. The value comes from drafting with human approval, not from software that invoices on its own.
3. The right first test is small and measured: line-level accuracy and time saved on a limited group of customers, before anything touches invoices, credit or collections.

Where the time goes

A typical order message is informal: a customer's own nickname for a product, a quantity in cases rather than units, a reference to 'the same as last week'. An experienced order clerk resolves this from memory and re-types it into the ERP. Multiply that by hundreds of messages a day and the order desk becomes a bottleneck, especially at month end.

Errors are expensive in a quieter way. A wrong product code or quantity reaches the customer as a wrong delivery or a wrong invoice, which then delays payment. Collections staff spend their time chasing what was, at root, an order-entry problem.

Where AI helps, and where people stay

AI earns its place in reading the message, matching it to the product master and the customer's history, and preparing a draft order that a person can approve in seconds. It can also produce a daily summary for the sales team and, later, help prepare polite payment reminders.

People should stay in charge of approving orders before they post to the ERP, at least until accuracy is proven; of pricing exceptions and credit decisions; and of every collections conversation that goes beyond a reminder. Payments themselves should run through licensed providers.

Personal data in messages fall under KVKK. The data that leave your systems, the legal basis for processing and the consent to message customers need to be settled before any pilot, not after.

Five common misreadings

“It worked in the demo, so it will work on our messages.” Your product nicknames, abbreviations and voice notes are what decide accuracy. Only a test on your own traffic tells you.

“Full automation is the goal.” The goal is fewer touches per order and fewer errors, not zero people.

“The ERP connection is the hard part.” Often the harder part is a messy product master and customer-specific naming.

“Collections automation is the quick win.” It carries the most reputational and legal risk. It comes after order accuracy is proven, and through licensed channels.

“We need a chatbot.” The work is in the workflow behind the chat window, not in the window itself.

Questions for the leadership team

1. How many orders a day arrive by message or voice, and how long does each take to key in?
2. What share of order errors concern product, quantity or price?
3. Is our product master clean enough to match customers’ own product names?
4. Who approves draft orders, and how quickly can they do it?
5. Which data would leave our systems, and on what KVKK basis?
6. Which ERP do we run, and who supports it?
7. What accuracy would we need to see before scaling?
8. What must never be automated in our business?

What a good first step produces

A useful first step is a draft-order pilot with a limited group of customers. Every draft is approved by your staff; nothing posts automatically. The pilot should leave you with measured line accuracy, measured time saved, and a clear decision on whether and how to extend it.

Ganrich Advisory designs the pilot, defines the measures and the decision gate, and works with your ERP partner and technology providers on the build. Software development and ongoing support are scoped separately.

Start a conversation

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About this paper. This paper reflects official sources checked on 21–23 October 2026. It is general information, not legal, customs, tax or engineering advice. Rules, thresholds and dates change; confirm them against official sources before acting. It describes no client work or results.

Sources: This paper draws on Ganrich Advisory's October 2026 review of opportunities in Türkiye. It describes a recommended test design, not client results.

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